Stronger and Clearer *Each Time*

Say it, sharpen it, say it again. Then write the answer that beats your first one.

HOW TO DO IT IN FIVE MINUTES

1 · 0:00

Ask one "why"

Post it with the frame "I think ___ because ___."

2 · 1 MIN

First draft

Silent write. Sketch, key words or home language are fine.

3 · 90 SEC

Partner 1

Explain without reading it. Listener asks both questions. Switch.

4 · 90 SEC

Partner 2

New partner, same questions. It should already sound better.

5 · 1 MIN

Rewrite

Stronger reasons, clearer words. **Underline one word you borrowed.**

EVERY LISTENER MUST ASK

"What do you mean by ___?"

"What's your evidence?"

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Math. Which phone plan is the better deal for 500 minutes, and why? Revise toward *rate, per minute, greater than*.

Science. Why do coastal Mississippi towns flood more after a hurricane? Revise toward claim + cause (*storm surge, as a result*).

Social studies. Why did the Mississippi River matter to the cotton trade? Revise toward claim + historical evidence.

ELA. What does the narrator want most, and how do you know? Revise toward claim + a quoted line.

THE FOUR LANES

Newcomer	Draft with a sketch, words or home language. Patient partner, word bank. Final: one framed sentence.
Emerging	Posted frame; questions read from a card. Final: 1–2 sentences with one unit word.
Progressing	No frame. Final uses one connective (*because, as a result, however*) and one unit word.
Challenge	Add "Someone might say ___, but ___." Push partners for precise evidence. Name what changed.

WHY IT WORKS

It puts into practice the one recommendation federal reviewers (What Works Clearinghouse) rate **Strong** for content teachers of ELs: daily partner talk about content, tied to writing. Routine by Jeff Zwiers. *Limits:* this five-minute version has not been tested on its own.

ELPA21 SPEAKING · LISTENING · WRITING

+ READING if from a text

WATCH OUT

Skipping the rewrite. Without step 5 this is only Talk Before Writing. Protect the last minute and use the underlined borrowed word as the exit ticket.